Minutes of the Special Strategic Planning Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Centre for Food, Durham College on Wednesday February 20, 2019 and Greenwood Discovery Pavilion on Thursday, February 21, 2019

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
		L. Bower

Day 1 – February 20, 2019, 12:00 p.m.

1. Call to Order

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 12:00 p.m.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Welcome, Introductions and Opening Remarks

Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, welcomed members of Council and the Senior Management Team to the Strategic Planning Meeting and thanked them for their participation. Rachael Wraith, Acting Manager of Public & Strategic Affairs, reviewed the strategic planning process and the results of the public engagement process undertaken by staff. R. Wraith introduced Susan Hall and Jim Faught, Lura Consulting, to lead the exercises throughout the meeting.

J. Faught reviewed the strategic planning framework:

- Our Ajax Promise;
- Focus Areas;
- Goals; and
- Action Items

4. Our Ajax Promise

J. Faught led the group through a visioning exercise to describe the Ajax of 2050. Members of Council discussed their individual visions for Ajax and the qualities that describe it, and were tasked with considering what can be done in the next four years to achieve that vision.

Members and staff divided into groups to discuss.

Members and staff reconvened into the larger and shared their collective findings.

Recess

The meeting recessed at 1:16 p.m.

The meeting resumed at 1:37 p.m.

5. Our Ajax Focus Areas

S. Hall led the group through an exercise to help determine the focus areas for the strategic plan. Members divided into groups to explore priorities and thematic connections between them. Following the exercise, members reconvened into a larger group and discussed the top four focus areas in general terms:

- Community Engagement/Diversity/Inclusion
- Business/Employment/Investment/Technology
- Leadership/Financial Sustainability/Governance
- Healthy/Connected/Active/Vibrant Communities

6. Wrap Up and Summary

R. Wraith reviewed the day's objectives and the outcomes of the exercises. Members of Council and the Senior Management Team returned to the Ajax Promise and explored potential wording and structure of the Promise statement.

Day 1 Adjournment

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: A. Khan

That Council adjourn the Strategic Planning Meeting until 8:30 a.m. on Thursday, February 21, 2019.

CARRIED

The Strategic Planning Meeting adjourned at 3:17 p.m.

Day 2

7. Call to Order

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at the Greenwood Discovery Pavilion at 8:30 a.m. on Thursday, February 21, 2019.

8. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

9. Review of Day 1 Outcomes / Ice Breaker

J. Faught reviewed the draft Ajax Promise and Focus Areas based on discussions during Day 1. S. Hall led Members through a warm-up exercise. Members discussed the draft wording of the Ajax Promise and the four Focus Areas, and explored the differences between the draft Focus Areas of engaging, investing, leading, and connecting.

10. Our Goals

Members broke into groups to discuss goals related to each of the Focus Areas, with attention to high level objectives for the Town. Following the exercise, Members reconvened into the larger group and discussed their identified goals and objectives as they relate to engaging, investing, leading, and connecting the community.

Recess

The meeting recessed at 10:15 a.m.

The meeting resumed at 10:30 a.m.

Members resumed their discussion and identified specific goals within each Focus Area that are priorities. Members of Council discussed concerns heard during the municipal election campaign and how goals and objectives may be developed to respond to those

concerns. Members of the Senior Management Team discussed priorities in each of their respective areas and how these priorities align with the goals and objectives of the strategic plan.

Recess

The meeting recessed at 11:15 a.m.

The meeting resumed at 12:40 a.m.

11. Prioritization of our Goals

R. Wraith reviewed the results of the public consultation for 22 top priorities for the year 2022. Members broke into groups to discuss, evaluate, and prioritize the feedback received from the public consultation. Following the exercise, members and staff reconvened into the larger group to discuss their findings.

12. Our Actions

Members of Council were each invited to review the feedback they heard during the municipal election campaign and discuss the priority actions they wish to pursue for the term of Council. Members and staff discussed how these actions align with the goals and Focus Areas for the strategic plan.

13. Discussion

Members of Council individually discussed other concerns and action items of importance to them, and their alignment with the strategic plan.

14. Wrap Up & Summary

Mayor Collier and S. Baker thanked all Members of Council and the Senior Management Team for participating in the Strategic Planning Meeting. It was noted that a subsequent meeting would be scheduled to review the draft strategic plan in the near future.

15. Confirming By-Law & Adjournment

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law number 17-2019 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its special strategic planning meeting held on February 20 & 21 2019 be read a first, second and third time and passed; and

That the February 20 and 21, 2019 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax Strategic Planning meeting be adjourned.

CARRIED

Mayor

D-Clerk